SAMPLE — FICTIONAL CLIENT, ILLUSTRATIVE ONLY

# DISCOVERY FINDINGS

*"It's the chicken, man."*

| | |
|---|---|
| CLIENT | **Los Pollos Hermanos** — fictional fried-chicken chain (SAMPLE brief) |
| PHASE | Phase 1 of 4: Discovery → Implementation Spec → Design Spec → Build |
| PREPARED | October 18, 2026 — Keith Soyka / GestaltView |
| PURPOSE | Record what was learned in discovery and set the direction for the spec phase. Nothing in this document is a design decision; everything here becomes an input to the Implementation Spec. |

PHASE 1 DELIVERABLE — SAMPLE

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Los Pollos Hermanos — "The Chicken Brothers" — is a fictional family-owned fried-chicken restaurant chain, "as seen on TV." This document is built entirely from a fictional sample brief; no real business data is represented anywhere in it.

| Attribute | Detail (fictional) |
|---|---|
| **Business** | Fictional fried-chicken restaurant chain |
| **Founded by** | Fictional brothers Gus Fring and Max Arciniega |
| **Known for** | Immaculate dining rooms, courteous staff, the famous curly fries |
| **The ask** | A modern 4-page marketing site to support catering inquiries and new-location announcements |
| **Locations (fictional)** | Albuquerque NM (Central Ave — flagship), Santa Fe NM, El Paso TX; new location coming: Tucson AZ |

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The fictional "why" behind the engagement, taken directly from the brief:

| # | Goal | How the site must answer it |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Look legitimate and appetizing — the site is the first impression for catering clients. | Premium, trustworthy first impression; brand-forward hero and value props. |
| 2 | Drive two conversions: **catering quote requests** and **franchise inquiries**. | Both conversion paths visible and reachable from every page; the contact page carries both. |
| 3 | Announce new locations without rebuilding the site each time (editable by a non-technical manager). | Locations and menu content isolated in plainly-marked, manager-editable regions. |
| 4 | Load fast on phones — most visitors arrive from social/ maps on mobile. | Mobile-first performance budget; no heavy assets; fast first paint on mid-range devices. |

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- **4 pages only:** Home, Menu, Locations, Contact.
- **No online ordering, no payments, no accounts.** Explicitly out of scope — stated plainly so scope stays bounded.
- **No real photography available.** The brand must be carried by CSS/SVG illustration and typography (sunburst hero, illustrated chicken badge, stripe dividers).
- **WCAG 2.1 AA contrast required** on all text. Copy in English only.
- **Handoff must be maintainable by a non-technical manager** — menu items and locations editable in plainly-marked spots, without code changes.
- **Design token set is fixed:** LPH red `#B3122E`, yellow `#FFC72C`, cream `#FFF6E5`, brown `#4A2C1A`, orange `#E87722`, red-dark `#7E0C20`. No hardcoded colors outside these tokens.

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What discovery surfaced that the spec phase must act on:

### 1 Two conversions, two audiences — one site must serve both

The site's success is measured by **catering quote requests** and **franchise inquiries** — two distinct visitor intents. Catering visitors are event planners seeking trust and appetite appeal; franchise visitors are investors seeking legitimacy and a clear path to contact. Both conversion paths must be present and unambiguous, with the Contact page carrying catering as the primary form and the franchise inquiry as a distinct, separate block (not a variant of the same form).

**DESIGN IMPACT:** dual-CTA hero ("Order Catering" + franchise path); Contact page split into two clearly-separated conversion zones.

### 2 Mobile-first audience — performance is a first-class requirement

Most visitors arrive from social and maps on phones. This is not a "responsive afterthought" situation: the design and performance budgets must be set mobile-first, with a fast first paint on mid-range devices over mobile connections. Every design choice — illustration complexity, font loading, form widgets — gets judged against load time.

**DESIGN IMPACT:** mobile-first layout spec; performance budget defined in the Implementation Spec before any design work begins.

### 3 No photography → the brand must live in CSS/SVG and type

No real photography is available, so "appetizing" must be delivered through illustration and typography alone: a sunburst hero, an illustrated chicken badge, retro-diner diagonal-stripe motifs, and a confident type pairing (Oswald headings, Inter body, Caveat for the tagline). The risk is a site that feels empty

**DESIGN IMPACT:** an illustrated brand component set (badge, sunburst, stripe dividers) becomes part of the design spec; no placeholder image slots that imply "photo goes here."

## 4 A non-technical manager must edit menu and locations — maintainability is a feature

The person maintaining this site is not a developer. Menu items (with prices, allergen note) and locations (addresses, hours, phones, "coming soon" announcements) must live in plainly-marked, clearly-labeled regions that a non-technical manager can find and edit without touching layout or logic. This is an acceptance criterion for "done," so the implementation must be structured for it from the start — not retrofitted.

**DESIGN IMPACT:** content regions explicitly zoned and labeled in the implementation spec; the handoff includes a short plain-language editing guide.

## 5 Scope is intentionally narrow — keep it that way

The brief explicitly excludes online ordering, payments, and accounts. These are the most likely scope-creep vectors (a "can't we just add a cart?" conversation). Discovery confirms the exclusions are deliberate and should be carried forward as stated constraints into the spec phase, with the 4-page structure treated as a hard boundary.

**DESIGN IMPACT:** the Implementation Spec restates out-of-scope items explicitly; any future addition is a new engagement, not an expansion.

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| Risk / Assumption | Likelihood | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|
| **R1 — Illustration quality gap:** with no photography, a weak illustration system makes the site feel generic rather than appetizing. | HIGH | Treat the SVG brand set as a first-class deliverable; validate appetite appeal at the mock-board stage before build. |
| **R2 — Scope creep into ordering/payments:** stakeholders request cart, checkout, or accounts mid-build. | MEDIUM | Out-of-scope items restated in the spec; additions priced as separate engagements. |
| **R3 — Manager-editable regions ignored in build:** content gets hardcoded into layout, making future edits require a developer. | MEDIUM | Zoning requirement in the Implementation Spec; verified against acceptance criterion 4 before handoff. |
| **R4 — Mobile performance regression:** design embellishments (fonts, sunburst effects) bloat load time on phones. | MEDIUM | Performance budget set in spec; verify on 360px mobile before sign-off. |
| **A1 — Fictional content is final for the sample:** menu items, prices, locations, and hours are invented and will not change. | ASSUMPTION | Any real engagement would re-run discovery against actual business content. |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **A2 — Catering inbox exists:** the quote form has a fictional destination inbox to deliver to. | ASSUMPTION | Form action and inbox address confirmed in spec phase (real projects: before build). |

### The one-sentence read

This is a **trust-and-conversion site**, not a catalog or a store: four pages whose entire job is to make a catering planner hungry and confident, give a franchise prospect a clear door to knock on, and let a non-technical manager keep it alive afterward.

### Spec-phase priorities (in order)

1. **Lock the conversion architecture first:** dual-CTA routing on every page; Contact page split into catering form (name, email, event date, guests, message) and a separate franchise inquiry block; 4-question FAQ (catering minimums, franchise info, allergens, hours).
2. **Define the illustrated brand system:** chicken badge, sunburst hero, stripe dividers — as named, reusable components, with the no-photography rule enforced (no empty "image goes here" slots).
3. **Zone the manager-editable regions:** menu items/prices/allergen note and the three locations (+ Tucson "coming soon") as plainly-marked, isolated content regions; pair with a plain-language editing guide at handoff.
4. **Set the mobile performance budget and AA contrast checks** as acceptance gates: 360px and 1280px verified, no horizontal scroll, keyboard-navigable nav and form.
5. **Restate the hard boundaries:** 4 pages, no ordering/payments/accounts — carried verbatim from discovery into the Implementation Spec.

Next deliverable: **Implementation Spec** — the build-ready technical contract this findings document feeds directly.

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